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Toh 586 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 586 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as the heart essence of the Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra, corresponding to the Sanskrit title Gaṇḍavyūhahṛdaya, meaning "The Heart of the Gaṇḍavyūha." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and distills the spiritual power of the celebrated Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra — the magnificent concluding chapter of the Avataṃsaka Sūtra describing the bodhisattva Sudhana's pilgrimage — into a concentrated series of mantric formulas and sacred pledges. The text promises that one who holds this dhāraṇī will thereby come to hold the essence of great sūtras such as the Sūtra of the King of Meditative Absorption, and will gain knowledge of the maṇḍalas, samaya, and mudrās of both worldly and transcendent realms. As a dhāraṇī belonging to the broader Vajrayāna liturgical tradition, it exemplifies the canonical tendency to crystallize vast sūtra teachings into brief, potent formulas intended for recitation and ritual practice.

One will come to recite them as a wooden text. One will come to know the maṇḍalas of all that is worldly and all that transcends the world, together with their sacred pledges (samaya). One will also come to know the mudrās.

The heart of the noble Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra is complete.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namas samanta-buddhānāṃ apratihata-śāsanānāṃ. Oṃ dhuna dhuna hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

By holding this dhāraṇī, one will come to hold the noble Sūtra of the King of Meditative Absorption. One will come to hold the noble Sūtra of the King of Meditative Absorption —

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "recite them as a wooden text" refers to the practice of oral recitation from a wooden xylograph or text-board, meaning one will be able to recite the entire text from memory as though reading from a printed source. This is a conventional Tibetan expression for fluent, text-perfect recitation.

The passage is transitional, closing the Gaṇḍavyūha section and opening a dhāraṇī colophon associated with the Samādhirāja Sūtra. The Sanskrit dhāraṇī is left in transliterated form as it is a mantra formula, not prose to be translated.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.